PsychArmor Midpoint Memo

To: PsychArmor project partners and MLD-371 instructional team

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Date: October 14, 2026

Subject: AI support for resume review and first-round screening

Overview

We propose an AI screening assistant for steps 5 and 6 of PsychArmor's hiring process: resume review and the first-round screening call. Applicants submit a resume and a recorded voice interview answering the same standard questions. The assistant organizes job-related evidence against a staff-approved checklist and drafts follow-up questions. PsychArmor staff verify the evidence and decide who advances; later interviews, work samples, and final decisions stay with people.

PsychArmor provides military culture education through courses, customized training, and consulting. [1] Our process map treats the 11-step hiring process as a set of hypotheses, rates each step's friction, and identifies which steps hold judgment worth keeping and which hold administrative cost worth reducing. [2] The process map, detailed tables, and pilot checklist appear in Appendices A through F. The goal is less repetitive review effort for staff, not fewer human decisions.

Process Map and Friction Hypotheses

Two steps carry high friction that is mostly administrative: resume review (step 5) and the first-round call (step 6). The map assumes an 11-step process of 14 to 21 weeks, with one to two weeks of waiting after each of those steps. [2] Every rating is a hypothesis to validate with staff; Appendix A maps them and Appendix B lists each step's hypothesis.

Worth optimizing. At step 5, each reviewer searches every resume for the same evidence. At step 6, staff schedule calls, ask the same standard questions, and scatter notes across documents. We hypothesize that automated evidence retrieval and a recorded interview remove most of this cost without replacing assessment. The job description (step 2) is worth optimizing lightly: observable criteria written once can feed the screening checklist. Reference checks (step 9) carry medium-to-high scheduling friction and are worth optimizing later, outside this pilot.

Worth keeping. Headcount approval (step 1), the panel interview (7), the work sample (8), and the offer (10) carry friction, but it is the cost of judgment about resources, ability, and the job itself, so these stay with people. Posting (3) and applying (4) carry little staff friction and should stay simple to avoid adding applicant burden. Background checks and onboarding (11) are outside waits PsychArmor cannot shorten.

The pilot tests three hypotheses at steps 5 and 6: reviewers repeatedly search resumes for similar evidence; scheduling initial calls delays screening; and information scattered across resumes, calls, and

notes makes consistent review harder. It will not shorten headcount approval, reference checks, or notice periods.

Theory of Change and Proposed Product

If staff define observable criteria and AI retrieves accurate evidence from resumes and transcribed answers, reviewers should spend less time searching and repeating standard questions. We will test whether this reduces total review effort and time to a next-step decision without missing qualifications or adding applicant burden.

1. **Configure the role.** The hiring manager approves required and preferred criteria, acceptable equivalent experience, the standard questions, and examples of sufficient evidence. One checklist version applies to every applicant.
2. **Collect materials.** Applicants receive the questions, notice of AI assistance, and a written or supported alternative. During an open window they upload a resume and record answers, re-recording as often as they like. Unreadable files or uncertain transcription go to a correction queue, never to an adverse judgment.
3. **Organize evidence.** For each criterion, the assistant shows a resume passage or transcript excerpt with its location and marks it located, partial or unclear, or not located. Missing evidence does not prove a skill is absent; conflicting statements become follow-up questions.
4. **Verify and decide.** Staff check sources, correct errors, request follow-up where needed, and record the decision. The tool does not rank, advance, reject, or hire anyone.

The recording supplies words only. The tool will not score tone, accent, speech rate, appearance, personality, emotion, or disability, a risk federal guidance flags for voice-based assessments. [4]

Scope of Final Deliverable

The final deliverable covers steps 5 and 6 only and has five components, each confirmed with PsychArmor's hiring owner before build (Appendix C). Role setup produces one approved question set and checklist, with required and preferred items and guidance on equivalent experience. Applicant intake provides resume and audio upload, an equivalent written route, applicant notice, and correction support. The reviewer workspace shows source-linked evidence, uncertainty flags, editable notes, and a human decision record.

The fourth component is an AI governance policy, adopted before any live applicant data is used. The fifth, evaluation and handoff, delivers a manual baseline, test cases, time and error findings, a user guide, and a manual fallback.

Out of scope: sourcing, panel interviews, work samples, reference and background checks, offers, and onboarding. Integration with existing hiring software depends on PsychArmor confirming its tools and access requirements.

AI Governance Policy

PsychArmor adopts the policy before the tool touches real applicant data; PsychArmor owns it. We draft the policy; PsychArmor approves it, maintains it, and answers for outcomes. PsychArmor also approves each role's checklist. The tool may retrieve and organize job-related evidence and draft follow-up

questions. It may not rank, advance, or reject applicants, or score voice, accent, emotion, appearance, personality, or disability. A person records every decision, and applicants receive advance notice and an equivalent non-AI route.

Applicant data stays in approved, restricted accounts under vendor terms that bar model training, and instructions embedded in applications are treated as untrusted content. The system logs checklist and model versions, source evidence, corrections, and decisions. California's automated-decision regulations, effective October 1, 2025, require keeping covered records at least four years; [3] PsychArmor confirms scope and legal holds before setting deletion schedules. PsychArmor tests accuracy and responses to identity cues before launch, pauses use if the tool invents evidence or misses qualifications, and reviews the policy after the pilot and at least annually.

Human review and bias testing do not by themselves establish legal compliance; employment protections still apply when AI is used. [5]

Pilot Evaluation and Next Steps

We propose a 25 percent cut in median total review effort as the pilot gate; at midpoint we claim no reduction. The test uses 12 to 20 synthetic applications with clear, incomplete, conflicting, and hard-to-transcribe answers. Two reviewers independently identify evidence and reconcile differences, then AI-assisted review is compared with the same checklist done manually. We count verification and correction time, and measure applicant effort and scheduling time separately.

Proposed gates: every evidence claim traceable, no fabricated quotations, at least 95 percent of checked citations supporting their claims, and at least 90 percent of reviewer-agreed evidence retrieved. A small synthetic test cannot establish population-level fairness or real scheduling savings. If a live call proves essential, we keep it and narrow the tool's role.

Next steps run in three stages. First, the hiring owner validates the role, requirements, application volume, baseline effort, and the friction ratings. Second, we build and test intake and evidence review, including accessible alternatives and irrelevant identity cues, while PsychArmor adopts the governance policy. Third, if approved, a limited parallel trial with human decisions leads to a recommendation to adopt, revise, or return to the manual process.

Sources

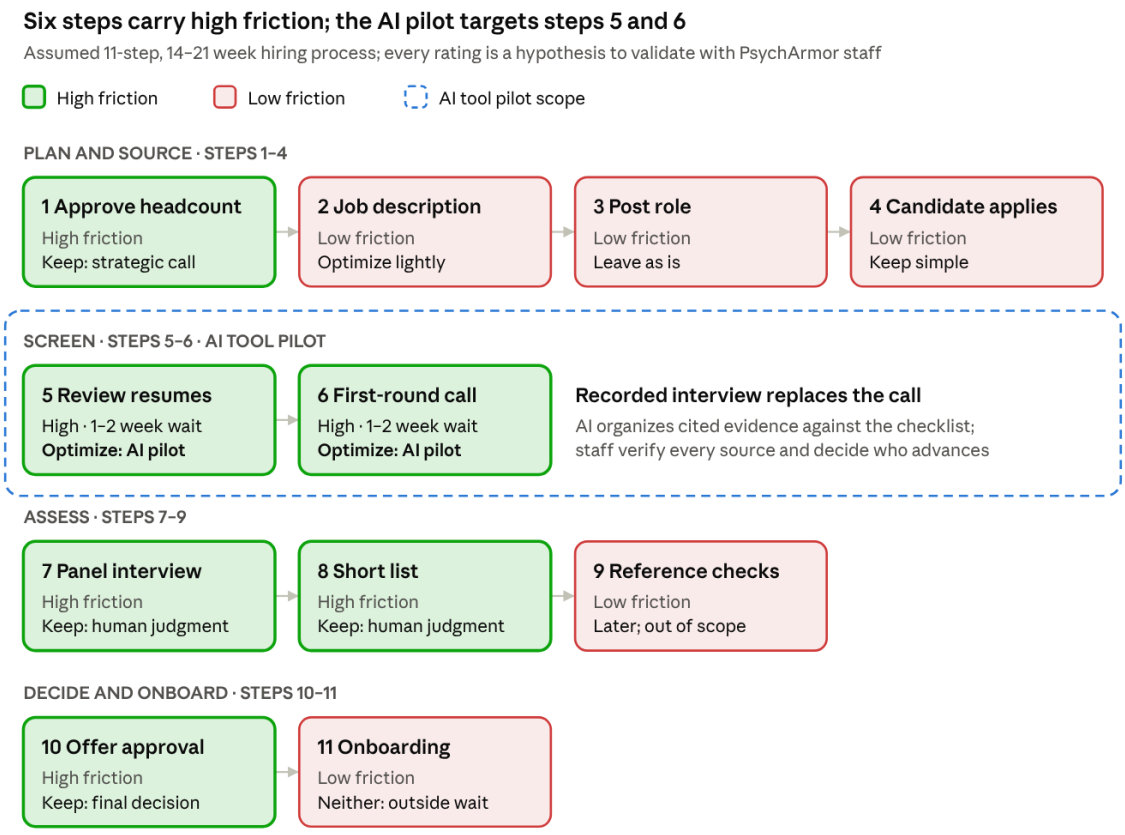
Web sources reviewed October 14, 2026. Pilot design and targets are our recommendations; workflow and timing come from the hypothesis map.

1. PsychArmor. Home page: organizational mission and services.
2. Kennedy Coders. PsychArmor Hiring Map, draft v2, October 8, 2026. Cites psycharmor.org/careers and /team; most process details are assumptions requiring staff validation.
3. California Civil Rights Department. Approval of automated-decision regulations, June 30, 2025; rulemaking record and final text.
4. U.S. Department of Justice. Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, and Disability Discrimination in Hiring, May 12, 2022.

Preparation note: AI assisted research synthesis, drafting, and formatting of this memo.

Appendix A: Hiring Process Map

The assumed 11-step process from the supplied hypothesis map, draft v2, October 8, 2026, rated for friction. [2]



Hiring friction map · 11 steps, 4 phases

Green marks high friction, red low; the dashed band is the pilot. Every step outside it stays with people, and Appendix B gives each step's hypothesis.

Appendix B: Friction Hypotheses by Step

Every rating is a hypothesis to validate with PsychArmor staff, not a measured baseline.

#	Step	Friction	Where the friction sits	Hypothesis	Keep or optimize
1	Identify need, approve headcount	Low	Waiting on budget sign-off	A strategic call on resources and mission	**Keep**

#	Step	Friction	Where the friction sits	Hypothesis	Keep or optimize
2	Write job description	Low	Drafted from scratch; vague "mission fit"	Observable criteria written once can feed the screening checklist	**Optimize**
3	Post role	Low	Routine posting	Little to gain	Keep
4	Candidate applies	Low (staff)	Applicant effort	Added steps would raise applicant burden	**Keep**
5	Review resumes	**High**	Each reviewer searches every resume for the same evidence; 1–2 week handoff	Automated evidence retrieval cuts search time without replacing assessment	**Optimize** (pilot)
6	First-round screening call	**High**	Scheduling; the same standard questions asked repeatedly; notes scattered; 1–2 week wait	A recorded interview with standard questions removes scheduling and repetition	**Optimize** (pilot)
7	Panel interview	High	Coordinating panel calendars	The conversation is core judgment; only logistics are costly	**Keep** judgment
8	Short List	High	Reviewer time	The most direct evidence of	**Keep**

#	Step	Friction	Where the friction sits	Hypothesis	Keep or optimize
				job performance	
9	Reference checks	Low	Scheduling calls with referees	Worth optimizing later	Keep
10	Approve and make offer	High	Approval chain	Final decision and negotiation belong to people	**Keep**
11	Background check, onboarding	Low	Third-party processing; notice periods	A fixed external constraint	Keep

Appendix C: Scope of Final Deliverable

Component	Deliverable	PsychArmor confirms
Role setup	One approved question set and checklist, with required and preferred items and guidance on equivalent experience	Role, requirements, which items belong in screening
Applicant intake	Resume and audio upload, an equivalent written route, applicant notice, correction support	Accessibility needs, notice wording
Reviewer workspace	Source-linked evidence, uncertainty flags, editable notes, a human decision record	Who reviews, existing hiring software
AI governance policy	A written policy for the tool's use (next section), adopted before any live applicant data	Policy approval, retention schedule, vendor terms
Evaluation and handoff	Manual baseline, test cases, time and error findings, user guide, manual fallback	Application volume, baseline staff effort

Appendix D: Next Steps

Stage	Action and completion condition
Validate	Hiring owner confirms the role, requirements, screening steps, volume, baseline effort, and friction ratings above.
Build and test	Implement intake and evidence review; test accessible alternatives and identity cues; fix material errors; adopt the governance policy.
Pilot and hand off	If approved, run a limited parallel trial with human decisions; recommend adoption, revision, or the manual fallback.
AI governance policy	A written policy for the tool's use, adopted before any live applicant data.